

Smart India Hackathon 2026 — what I need to ask

Harsh Bajpai · for faculty / the Programme Office · 11 September 2026

IIM Mumbai has no SPOC registered for SIH 2026. I checked the official list on sih.gov.in — no IIM in India is registered. A SPOC has to be a faculty member; a student cannot register.

The deadline may be 15 September. The official guidelines say 15th Sept; the same document says 30th Aug elsewhere and the press says 30 September. I have written to AICTE to confirm.

Our **AISHE code is U-1283**. As a university-level code we could nominate up to **100 teams**; I am asking about one.

My questions

1. Can the Institute **appoint a faculty member as SPOC** and register on sih.gov.in? I have the details ready — our AISHE code is **U-1283**, and the form needs only a faculty name, official email and phone number.
2. If the answer is no, **is that final for SIH 2026?** I am also enrolled at IIT Madras, which is already registered, and I would go through them instead. I am not asking anyone to say yes — I just need to know which door to use.
3. Who would **sign and seal the nomination letter** on Institute letterhead — the Director, or a Dean? It has to name all six team members and carry the Institute seal.
4. Can the Institute run a **short internal hackathon**? Only teams selected in one may be nominated, and the SPOC has to upload a report with photographs and jury details. If this is the part that makes it impractical, I would rather be told now than have it stall later.
5. Has the Institute **looked at SIH before and decided against it?** If there is already a position on this, I will stop asking.
6. If this year is not possible, would the Institute **register a SPOC for SIH 2027?** Registration opens around July. No IIM in India is currently on the national list, and that seems worth changing regardless of what happens to my team.
7. Is there **anyone else I should be speaking to** about this instead of you?

The project is ready — a working browser extension built for ISRO's problem statement SIH26171, running on Chrome and Firefox with tested, reproducible results. I am not asking the Institute to build anything, only to open the door.